

CAMBIO CARD GAME RULES

1 Introduction

Cambio is a memory card game played with a standard deck of cards. The goal of the game is to change the cards in your possession so that their total is as low as possible. Whoever has the lowest card total at the end of the game wins.

Card values

An Ace is worth 1 point, number cards are worth their rank (e.g., a 7 is worth 7 points), and face cards (Jack, Queen, King) are worth 10 points with one exception: either red King (K♥, K♦) is worth −1 points. Finally, Jokers are worth 0 points.

2 Setup

Each player is dealt four cards **face down** in a 2×2 grid—no one is to look at them. After they're dealt, everyone can **briefly** look at the **two cards** closest to them. After this glance, **no one is allowed to look at their cards again.**¹

The undealt cards are placed in the center as a draw pile, and whoever is to the left of the dealer starts the game. Players take turns in clockwise order.

3 Your turn

Draw a card. Only you can look at it. Then choose one of two actions:

- (1) Discard the drawn card.
- (2) Replace one of your face-down cards with the drawn card, then discard the replaced card.

Discarded cards are always placed **face up** on the discard pile.

¹Unless certain cards are discarded, as discussed in Section 4.

4 Card abilities

When certain cards are discarded **immediately after they are drawn**, they allow you to take special actions

Card	Ability
7 or 8	Look at one of your own cards
9 or 10	Look at someone else's card
Jack or Queen	Without looking at the cards' identities , swap any two players' cards
Black King (K♣, K♠)	Look at someone else's card, then swap any two players' cards

You aren't forced to use a card's ability, and cards lose their abilities after they are placed face down.

5 Matching

If you think that a face-down card has the same rank as the most recently discarded card, you can place the face-down card on top of the discard pile. This is called **matching**, and it may be done at **any time** during the game (i.e., out of turn).

You can attempt to match **any** face-down card, either one of your own or someone else's.

- If you successfully match one of **your own** cards, it does not need to be replaced.
- If you successfully match **someone else's** card, you get to replace it with one of your own.

Either way, you get to have one less card for the rest of the game.

But if you match unsuccessfully, you **gain** a face-down card from the draw pile (and you are not allowed to look at it).

A match can happen at most one time. If someone else beats you to a match, you're out of luck.

Keeping it fair

Since matching is a race, you must do it using only one hand. This is to limit the advantage of a player who drew a card which they think has the same rank as one of the face-down cards.

6 When does the game end?

A player may call "Cambio!" at the end of their turn. After this, each remaining player takes one final turn, and the game ends at the beginning of the next turn of the player who called "Cambio!" If no one ever does, the game ends when there are no cards left to draw.